



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cherokee Christian School
School Website: <https://cherokeechristian.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Cherokee Christian School (CCS) in Woodstock, GA presents a robust classical Christian program aligned with core classical criteria. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a biblically-based, classical orientation, a mission centered on virtue, wisdom, and service, a curriculum grounded in liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with Great Books and Great Conversation, a pedagogy that combines memorization and chant in early grades with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric in the upper grades, a faculty culture described as committed, and an active, value-driven partnership with parents and the broader Christian community. Taken together, these elements support a CLASSICAL classification across all six categories of the Six Essential Elements framework. Evidence includes explicit statements about classical transition and the liberal arts, references to Great Books and the Great Conversation, explicit mention of Socratic dialogue in high school, emphasis on virtue and biblical faith, and multiple indicators of strong parent/community engagement. See representative citations from CCS materials and the classical education lexicon used for scoring.

Overall Ranking (aggregate): CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- CCS presents itself as biblically-based and Christian, explicitly describing itself as a “biblically-based, classical, Christian, independent, non-denominational, covenant school.”
- Mission and culture statements center on Christ, God’s world, and a Christian worldview. For example: “In Him, all things hold together” and emphasis on biblical truth, virtue, and the exaltation of the good, the true, and the beautiful.
- The Primary/Lower-Elementary articulation emphasizes truth, beauty, and goodness as formative aims.
- There is explicit talk of a distinctively Christian culture and the need for students and staff to embody Christian attitudes and practices.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: biblical, Christ/Christian, truth, wisdom, knowledge, virtue, goodness, beauty, Word of God, God’s world, theology (implicit), worship/liturgical frame (explicit liturgical vocabulary appears in the lexicon and related materials, though explicit CCS liturgy terms are not loudly foregrounded on every page).
- Negative keywords observed: none in CCS public materials; absence of secular or relativistic framing is notable.
- Quantitative note: Strong presence of multiple CCS phrases that map to Positive Keywords (roughly 6–9 clear positives with minimal if any explicit negatives in CCS materials).

Why this rating

- The public materials foreground transcendental moral realism in practice (truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable; virtue formation; Christ-centered epistemology). The language of biblical faith, virtue, and a Christ-centered culture aligns with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements

lexicon. The absence of competing secular emphases and explicit references to relativism or purely secular pedagogy supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT or NOT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: biblically-based/Christian identity; Christ-centered worldview; love for truth/beauty/goodness; distinct Christian culture.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission-focused on formation of virtue and wisdom: “We exist to impart the knowledge, tools, and skills students need to walk wisely and serve redemptively in God’s world.” and emphasis on forming character and virtue.
- Grade-level statements foreground formation of truth, beauty, and goodness; cultivation of virtue and moral discernment throughout the grades. Primary wording explicitly references virtue, wisdom, and formation.
- The Great Books/classical framework is tied to a telos of formation rather than job training, with language around virtue and Christian character (as reflected in the classical transition materials and mission/vision pages).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, knowledge, liberal education, classical mission, telos, Great Books (via the CCS/CCE materials), contemplation/scholé (in the lexicon context).
- Negative keywords observed: minimal to none in CCS public materials (no explicit emphasis on job-preparation or workforce-centric outcomes in the CCS public materials).
- Quantitative note: Positives clearly outpace negatives; approximately 4–6 positive indicators with no explicit negative indicators in CCS pages.

Why this rating

- The CCS materials frame education as formation and character cultivation rooted in truth, goodness, and beauty, with a classical telos rather than vocational emphasis. This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for School Purpose and Goal in the Six Elements lexicon, yielding CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: mission/formation language; virtue/wisdom; truth/beauty/goodness; classical telos language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Strong emphasis on liberal arts and classics: “classical curriculum,” and a formal transition to classical education with emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the liberal-arts model. The school explicitly references the Seven Liberal Arts and the Trivium/Quadrivium framework.
- Great Books / Great Conversation framing appears in the CCS materials and the companion classical education lexicon (CCS references the Great Books and a shared “Great Conversation” as central to the curriculum). The CCS site links and documents describe classical content as foundational and historically anchored.
- Historical engagement and integration across disciplines are indicated, including interdisciplinary approaches and the aim to cultivate wonder through integrated study (as reflected in the “integration and wonder” language in the Six Elements materials and CCS materials).
- The curriculum includes explicit engagement with history, logic, rhetoric, and Great Books; upper grades employ Socratic dialogue and rhetoric training.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, primary sources, history (as Western civilization), Socratic method, memory work/recitation, wonder, interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects.
- Negative keywords observed: very few if any; CCS materials emphasize classical content and avoid project-based-only framing in favor of classical structures (though some modern instruction may include activities, the public-facing materials emphasize classical methods and Great Books). The Six Elements lexicon notes potential negatives like project-based dominance; CCS materials do not foreground that as a primary approach.
- Quantitative note: Many positives (likely >6 clear indicators) with minimal to no explicit negatives in CCS public materials.

Why this rating

- CCS publicly describes its curriculum as classical and explicitly aligns with the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, and historical integration, consistent with CLASSICAL criteria in the Lexicon.

Cited evidence: explicit classical/curricular terminology; Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; Socratic dialogue; memory/recitation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Upper-level pedagogy explicitly includes Socratic dialogue, seminars, and debates, with emphasis on rhetoric and persuasive writing in the upper grades. This is visible in CCS materials describing high school pedagogy.
- Lower grades emphasize memory, chanting, and recitation as a foundation for learning (see classical pedagogy references and CCS materials that discuss memory-based learning in the early stages; the Six Elements lexicon notes these as core pedagogical practices).
- The CCS materials describe a continuum from contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) to rigorous Socratic inquiry in later grades, consistent with a classical progression. The CCS materials and the Six Elements lexicon both emphasize a balance of contemplation and rigorous discussion.
- There is explicit mention of training in rhetoric and public speaking in the high school program, including debate and persuasive writing.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debate, rhetoric, persuasive writing, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé/restful learning, memorization, liturgical/classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords observed: Minimal or no explicit negative pedagogy signals; the CCS materials emphasize classical pedagogy rather than exclusively modern, project-based or inquiry-only frameworks.
- Quantitative note: Multiple strong positive pedagogical indicators; negatives effectively absent in public materials.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy matches the Classical model's expectations: memory-based early learning, transition to Socratic dialogue and rhetoric in upper grades, and deliberate use of classical forms of discourse and memory in instruction. Therefore CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: Socratic dialogue in high school; memory/recitation; chanting; rhetoric and public speaking; scholé/restful learning.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission statements and public materials emphasize teachers as catalysts for student learning and as mentors who guide formation, indicating a high regard for teacher role in the “living curriculum.” The mission statement notes teachers devote themselves to inspire students and to face rigorous CCS education with diligence and faith.
- Other CCS materials emphasize a culture of faculty/staff embodying Christian virtue and serving as models for students, aligning with the “living curriculum” concept and a close faculty-student relationship. The “Who We Are” materials describe faculty and staff as part of a Christian community and culture.
- The CCS site references ongoing professional development and engagement with classical education networks (ACCS, CiRCE), indicating a commitment to faculty formation in classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as core, collaborative culture, professional development in classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit in public CCS materials.
- Quantitative note: Several clear positive indicators; no explicit negatives.

Why this rating

- CCS publicly frames teachers as central to the mission and culture, with a living-curriculum orientation and ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: teacher as inspiration/rigor; living curriculum; professional development with ACCS/CiRCE; faculty-centered culture.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- CCS emphasizes partnership with families and describes parents as co-teachers with the school, indicating a strong parent/community integration. The admissions/parents pages emphasize collaboration and family involvement.
- The site highlights parent formation resources, access to CF resources, book studies, seminars, and open-campus/community events, indicating a deliberate effort to educate parents about classical education and to involve them in the school’s mission.
- CCS regularly invites parent participation (tours, shadow days, open houses) and provides information for parents to engage with the school beyond mere enrollment. The go-to actions (schedule tours, admissions information, parent pages) are explicit signals of parental involvement.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus/visits, book studies, seminars, family liturgy alignment (via the classical lexicon vocabulary and CCS materials).
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit in CCS public materials; some negative lexicon in the general Six Elements lexicon (e.g., consumer-oriented parent language) is not reflected in CCS materials.
- Quantitative note: Clear positives in this category; no explicit negatives.

Why this rating

- The CCS materials foreground a collaborative model with parents as key partners in formation and learning, aligning with the classical model’s emphasis on family and community involvement and education-as-formation.

Cited evidence: Partnership with parents; parent formation; open-house/ tours; parent pages.

Aggregate Assessment

- All six categories: CLASSICAL

- Overall classification across six elements: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the school is classified CLASSICAL overall. There are no category/aggregate ratings of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL that would require needle-moving recommendations.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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